government or the governments of other Commonwealth countries recognizing China before India did. He would then be seen as a camp-follower of the British instead of a world statesman. The Chinese state-run media had already irked the Government of India by alleging that India was a 'lackey' of the capitalist bloc. His concerns were magnified by the American attempts to create a like-minded community of Asian countries, which Nehru felt would be 'honestly regarded or wilfully misrepresented as designed to promote formation of anti-Communist bloc in Asia.' [25] So concerned was Nehru with avoiding a misunderstanding with China on this matter that he wrote to President Sukarno of Indonesia in December 1949 to tell him that India was not proposing to join up with any international activity that might appear to be against China. He urged Indonesia to follow suit. [26] Finally, public and diplomatic pressure had begun to mount on the Government of India for rendering some form of assistance to the Tibetan government, and Nehru wanted to avoid giving any impression to China that India would act in bad faith on the Tibet issue.

For all these reasons, the timing of the recognition became the focal point for the Government of India. Other, more tangible objectives relating to India's interests or concerns, including the northern frontier and the status of Tibet, which might have formed an important part of the negotiating strategy during the talks with China, were nowhere to be seen. This might also explain why there was no reference in Prime Minister Nehru's note of 17 November 1949 on what specific outcomes India wanted from the negotiations with China for diplomatic recognition, beyond the fact of the recognition itself.

The Government of India also made another presumption, which was erroneous and would prove disadvantageous to India in the negotiations. India assumed that its official declaration recognizing the People's Republic of China would